

Mehdi Mahfoudi

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HEAD OF INFRASTRUCTURE · CLOUD & PLATFORM LEAD

14+ years designing, securing, and scaling mission-critical infrastructure—from high-security sovereign datacenters to modern Cloud, Kubernetes, and AI platforms. Driven by automation, FinOps efficiency, and offensive/defensive cybersecurity.

14+	-75%	Zero-Trust	GCP · K8s · AI
Years in Infra, Cloud & Security	GCP Cloud Bill Reduction (FinOps)	Sovereign Infra, WIF & System Hardening	Cloud Platforms, Bare Metal & AI Agents

Professional Experience

Head of Infrastructure
Jan 2024 – Sep 2026

relevanC · Paris, France

- Owned cloud & platform strategy for a 15-engineer org: standardized shared GCP platforms with Terraform/Terragrunt and ArgoCD (GitOps).
- High-impact FinOps: drove architectural rightsizing and commitment optimizations, cutting the GCP bill by over 75%.
- Enforced Zero-Trust security (keyless Workload Identity Federation) and built AI agents automating platform & security workflows.

Senior Site Reliability Engineer
Sep 2022 – Dec 2023

Scaleway · Paris, France

- Automated and operated large-scale hypervisor fleets (Virtual Instances, Bare Metal) and high-density GPU clusters for the AI Supercomputer.
- Low-level systems engineering, virtualization, and orchestration across KVM/QEMU, Proxmox, Kubernetes, and Ansible.

Senior Cloud Engineer
May 2021 – Aug 2022

MeilleursAgents · Paris, France

- Scaled and hardened high-traffic production GKE clusters; automated infrastructure with Terraform, Ansible, Jenkins, and ArgoCD (GitOps).

Cloud Engineer
Nov 2019 – Apr 2021

PathMotion · Paris, France

- Owned end-to-end GCP platform (GKE, Cloud Run, Cloud SQL) provisioned via Terraform and automated CI/CD with CircleCI.
- Rolled out Instana APM & SLI/SLO observability (-15% K8s VMs), authored as a guest post on the official Instana blog.

Senior Linux System Administrator
Apr 2019 – Oct 2019

Talend · Suresnes, France

- Deployed multi-site Icinga monitoring and engineered modular Ansible roles continuously tested on AWS via Travis CI.

Lead Sysadmin / Infrastructure Architect
Sep 2016 – Mar 2019

Direction Générale de la Sécurité Intérieure (DGSI) · Levallois-Perret, France

- Infrastructure Team Lead: architected and operated mission-critical sovereign datacenters under stringent security constraints.
- Enforced system hardening & cryptography (SELinux, PKI/TLS, GPG, YubiKey), network-diode air-gapping, and ELK security logging.

System & Virtualization Administrator
Dec 2014 – Aug 2016

Direction Nationale de la Police Aux Frontières (DNPAF) · Paris, France

- Redesigned the national VMware vSphere virtualization infrastructure and maintained core Active Directory services.

Linux System Administrator
Jul 2012 – Dec 2014

Direction Centrale du Renseignement Intérieur (DCRI) · Levallois-Perret, France

- Industrialized Linux server fleets (Debian, RHEL/CentOS) on VMware and deployed Nagios / Shinken monitoring.

Core Expertise

Cloud & Infrastructure
Google Cloud Platform (GCP) · Scaleway · Bare Metal · KVM / QEMU · Proxmox · VMware vSphere

Kubernetes, IaC & GitOps
Kubernetes (GKE) · ArgoCD · Terraform · Terragrunt · Ansible · GitLab CI · GitHub Actions

Cybersecurity & SecOps
Workload Identity Federation · Zero-Trust · SELinux · PKI / TLS / GPG · YubiKey · Network Diodes · Pentesting (Linux & Windows)

Observability, FinOps & AI
SLI / SLO · Grafana · Prometheus · Cloud FinOps · AI Agents

Security Training & Publications

Pentesting Linux Systems
Synacktiv — Offensive Security

Pentesting Windows Systems
Synacktiv — Offensive Security

How PathMotion Future Proofs Their Cloud-Agnostic Platform with Instana
Nov. 2020 — Authored Post

Senior ICT Technician Competitive Examination
2014 — Award

Education

CNAM — Sécurité Défense 2011 – 2012
Cyberdefense Program · Computer Networks & Telecommunications

Czech Technical University (ČVUT) 2010 – 2011
Erasmus Exchange · Networking & Telecommunications

Université de La Rochelle — IUT 2008 – 2010
Associate Degree (DUT) in Networks & Telecommunications

Languages & Interests

French (Native) · **English** (Full professional proficiency)

Brazilian Jiu-Jitsu (BJJ) · Cooking · Badminton